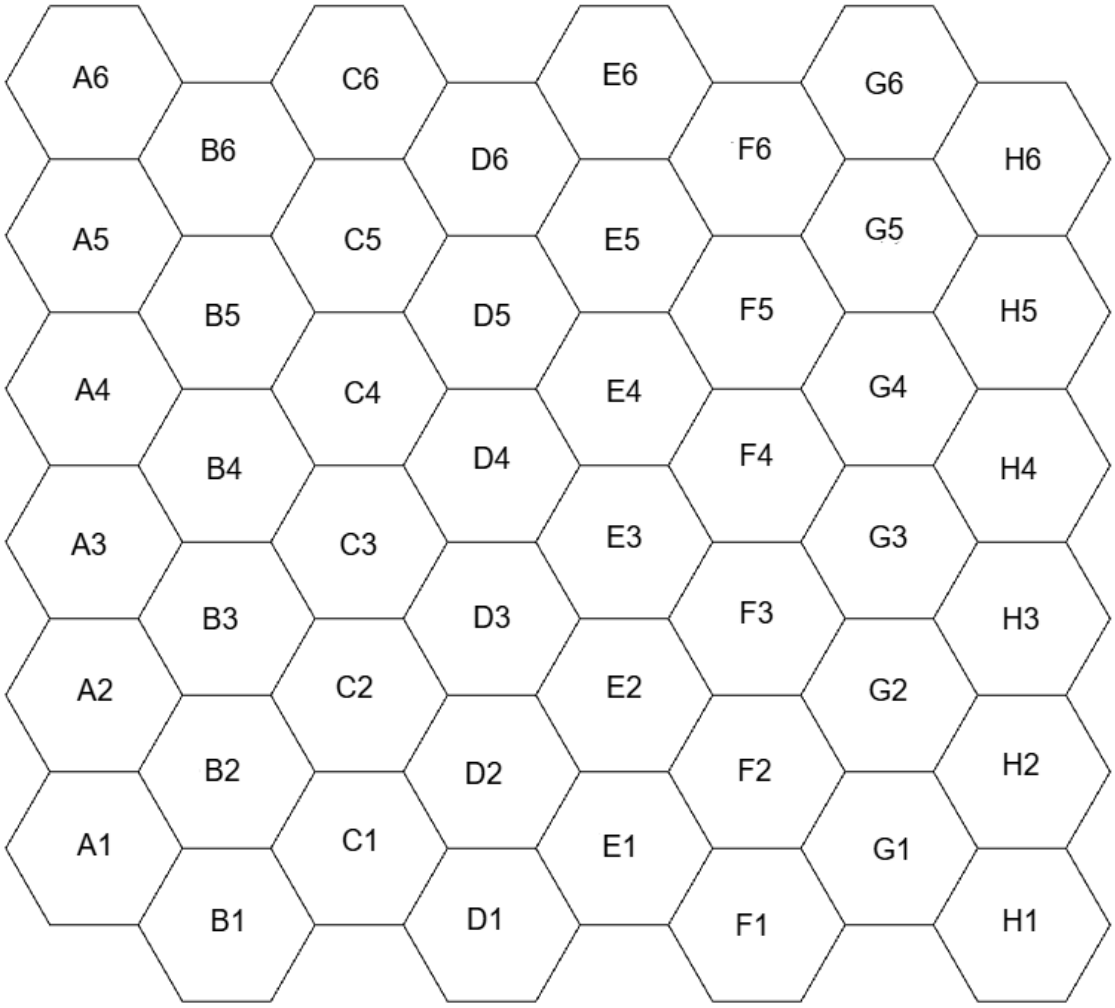
EVIL

-Card Game-
(*First Playtest Edition*)



Official Rules

Board

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1. The game takes place on an 8x6 board of hexagonal tiles, with rows labelled 1-6 and columns labelled A-H. The orientation of the tiles is such that the top and bottom of each tile are flat, and columns are offset so that the tiles interlock (*each tile should be just large enough for 1 card, making each side of the board roughly about the size of an average playmat*).

Preparation

2. Each game has 2 players. Each player starts with their own deck of exactly 40 cards, containing no more than 3 of the same card.
3. Before the game starts, both players must shuffle their decks until they are sufficiently randomized.
4. To start the game, one player must flip a coin while the other calls the result. If the player calling the flip calls the result correctly, they choose which player goes first. If the player calling the coin calls the result incorrectly, the other player chooses which player goes first. Then, once a player is chosen this way, each player draws 7 cards from their deck.
5. Before starting the game, players complete the setup step. To do this, both players take turns choosing to reinforce 1 unit, cycle, or start, beginning with the player who goes first. A player who chooses to start may change their mind if the other player reinforces, but not if they agree to start. When both players have chosen to start, they each begin to take gameplay turns beginning with the player chosen to go first.
    5.1. A player who is unable to reinforce or cycle during this step must choose to start.
    5.2. A player choosing to cycle may reveal any number of units *that they are unable to reinforce into play*. That player then places those cards on the bottom of their deck in any order and draws that many cards. Each player may only cycle once per setup phase.
    5.3. Until both players choose to start, no abilities on cards are considered to be active. This means players cannot use actions yet at this time, and the passives on their cards do not yet have any effect.

Gameplay

6. Each gameplay turn consists of either choosing a unit in play to take the turn, or reinforcing 1 unit card from hand into play.
    6.1. Unless otherwise specified, "turn" refers to a gameplay turn and not a unit's turn. This means that effects starting at the beginning of the player's turn happen before that player chooses a unit to take the turn.
    6.2. When a unit is chosen by the player who controls it to take a turn, that unit's AP is set to the number of AP printed on its card. That unit must then perform actions

until it is unable to perform any more, or that player chooses to “pass”, at which point the next player begins their turn.

6.2.1. After the AP of the chosen unit is set, both players may activate *~Assist~* abilities from their hand (*see ~Assist~, for which effects happen first see effect*).

6.2.2. Each unit may choose to use the two universal actions: move and draw.

6.2.3. Only a unit currently taking a turn has its current AP tracked. Effects in play which change a unit’s AP only apply if the affected unit begins to take a turn.

6.2.4. After a unit's AP is set, all "start of turn" and "when this unit takes a turn" effects trigger before that unit may take actions.

6.2.5. The same unit can be chosen to take a turn any number of times, even if it was chosen during its player’s last turn.

6.2.6. A unit that has 0 AP remaining may still continue its turn by taking Actions if it is able to ignore AP cost.

6.2.7. Control of a unit is denoted by the orientation of the card (*text facing its controller while the board is being represented*). For the purpose of the game, a card’s owner is the player who played the card, and ownership cannot change throughout the game (*though control of a unit can*).

6.2.8. If both players each “pass” ten times in a row, the game ends in a draw.

7. In addition to the numbered game rules, the **Glossary of Terms** below defines the meaning of underlined words listed in these rules. This rule gives the status of official rules to these definitions as they pertain to gameplay.

Victory

8. A player wins when their opponent has no more non-token units left on the board.
   8.1. Victory is checked immediately after all pending effects resolve and all defeated units are moved to graveyards.
   8.2. If both players would end up with no more non-token units left on the board at the exact same time, the game ends in a draw.

Glossary of Terms

- **Action-** Refers to using either an ability on a card or a universal action, either by spending AP or by ignoring AP cost.
  - **Ability-** a unit must spend the AP cost listed on its card. Doing so grants the effect written on the ability.

        - When an ability is used, any reference to “this unit” on the ability refers to the unit using the ability, not the unit which has the ability printed on its card.
        - Using an ability for free as another ability is still using that ability, so its targeting restrictions and usage limits still apply unless an effect says otherwise. The effects of the free ability count as the effects of the other ability while doing this, meaning that, together, the original ability and the free ability count as only 1 ability. An ability used by a card it is not directly printed on still obeys its own targeting restrictions and usage limits.
            - Abilities used by ignoring their AP costs do not count toward this rule and are still counted as an additional ability.
        - If an ability has an AP cost containing a hyphen, its controller chooses one legal number including or between the numbers on either side of the hyphen when it is used and treats this number as the ability’s AP cost, unless the effect causing it to be used specifies another AP cost.
            - When an ability with a hyphenated AP cost is used without paying its cost (for free, borrowed, or ignoring cost), the effect allowing it names an AP amount, and it is used as though that many AP were spent. It counts as an ability of that cost only if the amount is within its printed range.
    - **Universal actions-** These are actions that may be used by any unit unless specified on the card.
        - **Universal draw action-** Defined as “**Draw (1AP):** Draw 1 card. Use only once per turn.” All units have access to this action by default (*it will not appear on the card, but they may still use it unless specified on the card*).
            - Effect referring specifically to the universal draw action as opposed to other sources of draw will mention it by this name (*the universal draw action*).
        - **Universal move action-** Defined as “**Move (1AP):** Choose one of the empty tiles surrounding this unit. This unit is now placed on that tile.” All units have access to this action by default (*it will not appear on the card, but they may still use it unless specified on the card*).
            - Effects referring specifically to the universal move action will use the term “moves”, “moving” or other derivatives of the word “move”.
            - A unit that moves multiple tiles is treated as entering and leaving each intermediate tile in sequence.
            - **Cannot move-** A unit that cannot move cannot use the universal move action and cannot be moved by effects that use the word "move". It may still be placed, swapped, pulled, knocked back, or otherwise have its tile position changed by effects that do not use the word "move".

- **AP-** The resource used by units in order for players to take their turn (*short for “action points”*).

- **Armour-** When a unit with armour takes damage, it loses that number of armour first before damage counters are placed. Then, put that many fewer damage counters on it. If the

damage resulted from an effect that hits or deals damage again, this happens before any additional hits or any additional damage.
    - **Armour up to [number]-** Effects that allow a unit to armour up to a number denote a maximum amount of armour that can be gained from that effect. A unit that already has higher armour than the number cannot use such an ability. A unit that already has armour of a lesser number may use the ability to gain additional armour until the total amount of armour equals that number.
        - If armour up to is only part of an ability, a unit already above that amount of armour can still use that ability, but the "amour up to" part of the ability does not happen. The rest of the ability still happens.
    - **Bypassing armour-** An effect with this term deals damage to other units as though they have no armour, even if they do.
        - **Bypassing up to [number] armour-** An effect with this term deals damage to other units as though they have that number less armour, even if they do.

- ***~Assist~-*** A unit with an assist ability may be placed from its owner's hand onto an empty tile on their back row (*Row 1 or Row 6, depending on which player*) as a react effect when either player chooses a unit to take a turn (*this is not reinforcing*). After doing so, that unit uses its ~*Assist*~ ability immediately, as a react effect for free. After the ability and all effects it causes happen, the unit with the ~*Assist*~ ability is then immediately moved to its owner's graveyard.
    - "*~Assist~"* has no effect when printed on the ability of a unit that is already in play (*the effect only works from a player's hand)*.
    - Units using ~*Assist*~ abilities are considered to be in play. Any passives of a unit using an ability as an ~*Assist*~ take effect.

- **Attack-** An ability dealing damage to another unit counts as an "attack" for the purposes of other effects. Only abilities are attacks. Passive effects may deal damage but they do not count toward this designation (*passives are not attacks*).
    - An attack with a stated range (*including melee*) requires at least one legal target when it is declared.
    - **Hit-** Refers to an instance of damage from an attack. Affecting the damage of an attack does not affect the number of hits unless specified (*the effect increases the damage of each hit)*. Each hit takes place against the remaining armour and hp *after* the previous hit (*they are not simultaneous*). Attacks with no specified number of hits are considered to hit once.
    - **Ranged attack-** A ranged attack is any attack not stated as melee, regardless of the range from which it was used (*see range*).
    - **Melee attack-** A melee attack is considered to have a range of 1 (*see range*), but is not considered a ranged attack.
        - An attack used at range 1 does *not* count as melee unless specified.

- **Cycle-** An effect on a card allowing that card to be moved from a player's hand to the bottom of their deck, after which that player may draw a card. During the setup phase, there is a cycle step where this can uniquely be done to any number of cards at once as long as they are unable to be reinforced into play.

- **Damage-** Damage is a type of effect. A unit that has taken damage equal to or in excess of its HP is moved to the graveyard after all current effects have taken place.

    - **Prevent Damage-** If damage would be prevented, treat it as though that amount of damage was never dealt (*do not place damage counters or remove armour*). If more damage would be prevented than the amount being dealt, prevent it all. Other effects besides damage resulting from the same ability or passive as the effect causing damage happen as normal.
    - Damage is marked using damage counters.

- **Draw [number]-** The act of a player putting the specified number of cards into their hand from the top of their deck (*See Action- Universal Actions- Universal Draw Action*).
    - If there are fewer cards in a player's deck than the amount they would draw, they draw them all. If there are no cards in a player's deck, they cannot activate an ability that would cause them to draw unless it has other effects (*those effects still happen*), and a passive that would cause them to draw does nothing.

- **Effect-** A catch-all term referring to game actions resulting from abilities or passives.
    - If more than one effect would happen at the same time, including react effects (*see react*), the effect(s) belonging to the player whose turn it currently is happen first. If more than one effect controlled by the same player happens at the same time, that player chooses which order they happen.
    - If an effect no longer has a valid target before it happens, that effect does not happen (*the AP cost remains paid and is not refunded*).
    - **Scorched-** An effect that can be placed on a tile temporarily by another effect. Units moving onto or off of a scorched tile take 4 damage.

- **Enemy-** A unit with reference to another that is controlled by the other player.
    - **Enemy back row-** the row where, from a player's perspective, their opponent reinforces their units (*see reinforce*).

- **Friendly-** A unit with reference to another that is controlled by the same player.
    - Units may not target friendly units for an attack, but effects of units that do not target friendly units may cause them to damage friendly units unless otherwise specified.

- **Gameplay Turn-** A gameplay turn begins when a player begins choosing either a unit to take a turn or a unit to reinforce, and ends when the next player begins their gameplay turn.

- **Graveyard-** Refers to a pile beside the game board for cards removed from play. Each player's graveyard is kept separate from the other's.

- **Heal [number] damage-** To heal a number of damage from a unit, remove that number of damage counters from it. If there are fewer damage counters on a unit than would be removed through this effect, remove them all.

- **HP-** The resource listed on a card tracking a unit's maximum capacity to take damage (*short for "hit points", see damage*).
    - Effects referring to a unit at full HP refer to units with no damage counters on them.

- **Immune to [effect]-** If a unit that is immune to an effect, effects of that type used against that unit do nothing. Other effects of abilities causing those effects happen as normal.

- ***~Inspiring~-*** An ability with the ~*Inspiring*~ keyword can be used by other units during their turn. To do so, at any time and as an effect, the player taking a turn must reveal the card with the ~*Inspiring*~ ability from their hand and put it in their graveyard. Then, for the rest of the turn, the unit taking the turn gains the ~*Inspiring*~ ability and may use it by paying its AP cost.
    - "~*Inspiring*~" has no effect when printed on the ability of a unit that is already in play (*the effect only works from a player's hand)*.

- **Knockback-** An effect causing a target unit to be placed a number of tiles in a straight line away from its attacker, passing through each tile in the way, if able. If another unit's position or the board boundary makes this impossible, it does not happen (*knockback does not go through units*). If it is otherwise possible it happens, even if it causes other effects to happen. The unit knocked back is treated as though it passed through each tile along the direct path for effects happening this way.
    - If a ranged ability would apply knockback, the direction of the knockback is instead considered to be the same direction as the path of the ability went most recently (*the same ability may then produce different knockback directions depending upon the path chosen by the player*).

- **Loot [number]-** To loot a number, a player draws that number of cards, then puts back the same number of cards from their hand to the bottom of their deck in any order.
    - If there are fewer cards in a player's deck than the amount they would loot, that player loots them all. If there are no cards in a player's deck, they cannot activate an ability that would cause them to loot unless it has other effects (*those effects still happen*), and a passive that would cause them to loot does nothing.

- **Move/Moving/Movement-** (*See Action- Universal Actions- Universal Move Action*)

- **Passive-** A passive is an effect written on a card or token that is persistent and active during all turns after players start the game (*they are not active during setup*). These effects take place without spending AP unless specified on the passive.
    - If a passive is activated by an action, the passive activates as would a react effect (*after the AP cost of the action but before it takes effect*).

- **Range [number]**- The number of tiles the target of an ability is allowed to be from the user of an ability, creating a path one tile at a time. If multiple legal paths exist between the user and target, the controller chooses the path when declaring the ability. Units along the path of a ranged ability do not prevent it from being used or hitting its target unless specified. To legally use an ability, the target tile or unit, if applicable, must be within range.
    - **Behind-** The specific tile position with reference to another that is 1 row closer to the enemy back row (*from the perspective of the effect's controller),* or on said back row, and in the same column. Units on a back row have nothing behind them (*because of the board boundary*).

    - **Cannot be targeted**- A unit that cannot be targeted cannot be chosen as the target of an effect. It may still be affected by effects that target tiles or affect the unit without targeting it.
    - **Surrounding-** Refers to all of the up to 6 tiles within range 1 of a tile, or to units thereon.
    - **Straight Line:** A sequence of connected tiles where each step passes through the exact opposite side of the next tile in sequence. On a hexagonal board, this limits straight lines to 6 fixed directions (*3 straight axes*). A straight line can never bend, curve, or alternate directions.
    - **Targets tile-** An ability that targets a tile may be used on that tile regardless of whether or not any units are on it.

- **React-** A react effect on a unit takes place when a certain condition is met. When that condition is met, the effect takes place before other effects. Any effects which were declared and had any applicable AP costs paid or ignored then happen after the react effect (*enemy units dealt damage in excess of their HP by a react effect are moved to the graveyard only after all current effects have taken place, see damage*).
    - Because it does not die until after all current effects have taken place, an ability from a source that would be killed by a react effect will still happen. After this, the unit is sent to the graveyard as normal.
    - React effects may trigger other react effects. They each happen before the effect originally used as the condition for the first react effect (*for which player's react effects happen first, see effect*).

- **Reflect-** A reflected ability happens twice: First, it happens as normal. Then, as a separate ability, the target uses the same ability for free as though it were their own against the unit that originally used it.

- **Reinforce:** When a player is able to reinforce, they place a unit card from their hand onto an empty tile on the back row (*Row 1 or Row 6, depending on which player*). If there are no empty tiles on their corresponding back row, that player may not reinforce this way. If the unit being reinforced does not say "basic unit" and instead has one of the following terms, apply its unique reinforce rule instead:
    - **Promote a ([requirement]/Basic Unit):** Reinforce this card by choosing 1 friendly unit on your side of the board with a word in its name matching the requirement if there is one, or else any friendly basic unit. Place this card from your hand onto the tile occupied by the chosen unit, placing the chosen unit's card underneath it. The card underneath is referenced on this card as the "promoted card", if applicable. The chosen unit becomes the unit on this card. Keep its card permanently beneath this card regardless of its tile position. All damage counters on the chosen unit are moved onto this card unless their number exceeds the number of HP on this card, in which case a player cannot reinforce this way. All effects other than damage on the promoted unit end when this happens.
    - **Fusion: [number] ([requirement(s)]/Basic Unit(s)):** Reinforce this card by choosing [number] friendly units on your side of the board each with a word in its name matching a requirement if there are any, or else any friendly basic unit(s), forming a single connected group through surrounding tiles. Place this card from your hand onto one of the tiles occupied by a chosen unit, placing all chosen units

underneath it. Any other tiles that were occupied by the chosen units are left empty. The cards placed underneath are referenced on this card as the “promoted cards”. The chosen units become the unit on this card. Keep their cards permanently beneath this card regardless of its tile position. All damage counters on the chosen units are moved onto this card, unless their number exceeds the number of HP on this card in which case a player cannot reinforce this way. All effects other than damage on the promoted units end when this happens.

- **Tribute: [number] ([requirement]):** Reinforce this card by choosing an empty tile on your back row (*Row 1 or Row 6, depending on which player*) and choosing [number] friendly basic units on your side of the board each with a word in its name matching the requirements if there are any such that all requirements are met. Send these units to the graveyard, then place this card from your hand onto that tile. If there are no empty tiles on their corresponding back row, you may not reinforce this way.
- **Requirement-** A reinforcement requirement may be a single word or word-set (*with and/or meaning any combination counts*), or multiple requirements joined by '+', each of which must be satisfied by a different unit in the group.

- **Side of the Board-** Each player’s side of the board consists of either the tiles in rows 1-3 or the tiles in rows 4-6, depending upon which player.

- **Stack-** Refers to the property allowing the same effect to affect the same unit more than once at the same time. By default, effects do stack (*they can be used more than once on the same unit)* unless specified.
  - A unit may not take an action that would cause an effect to stack if it says it does not stack, unless that action has other effects attached. In this case, the other effects happen as normal and the effect still does not stack.

- **Tile Position-** Refers to the coordinate of the tile a unit is currently on. With the rows labelled 1-6 and the columns labelled A-H, all of the specific possible tile positions are: A1, A2, A3, A4, A5, A6, B1, B2, B3, B4, B5, B6, C1, C2, C3, C4, C5, C6, D1, D2, D3, D4, D5, D6, E1, E2, E3, E4, E5, E6, F1, F2, F3, F4, F5, F6, G1, G2, G3, G4, G5, G6, H1, H2, H3, H4, H5, and H6.

- **Token-** A token is a unit represented by an object other than a game card. (*tokens are kept strictly separate from game cards and outside of the game, not to be used in decks, and only to be put into play through unit effects.)*
  - **Obstructing Wall-** A token with (12HP / 0AP) and no abilities.
  - **Raging Bonfire-** A token with (12HP / 0AP) and **Passive- Blazing Fixture:** This unit cannot move. For as long as this unit is in play, all tiles surrounding it are scorched (*units moving onto or off of a scorched tile take 4 damage*).